

ZIHENG YU

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Department of Economics ◇ The University of Texas at Austin

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin

Austin, TX, USA

Ph.D. in Economics

Aug 2021 - May 2027 (Expected)

- Field courses: Theory, Public Finance

Duke University

Durham, NC, USA

M.A. in Economics

Aug 2019 - Dec 2020

Wuhan University

Wuhan, Hubei, China

Bachelor in Economics

Sep 2015 - Jun 2019

REFERENCES

Thomas Wiseman (Supervisor)

Professor of Economics

Department of Economics

The University of Texas at Austin

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David Sibley (Co-Supervisor)

John Michael Stuart Centennial Professor

Department of Economics

The University of Texas at Austin

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V. Bhaskar

Sue Killam Professor

Department of Economics

The University of Texas at Austin

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RESEARCH

Fields and Interests

Microeconomic Theory, Game Theory, Theoretical Industrial Organization, Platform Competition, Market Structure, Bargaining, Information Design

Working Papers

- “The Case of Apple’s Restrictions on Super Apps: Is the U.S. Department of Justice Right?” (**Job Market Paper**)

Abstract: The novel “super app” technology, which emerged in the early 2010s, enables app developers to run a single version of an app on different operating systems. Apple’s alleged practice of restricting super apps in the United States is one of the subjects of a recent antitrust complaint filed by the U.S. Department of Justice (2024). I present a model of a two-sided market with cross-side network effects to investigate two questions: why Apple restricts super apps in the United States but not in Asia; and whether its restrictions may adversely affect market competition and welfare in the United States. I find that a primary reason for Apple’s behavior is the dominant position of its iOS platform on the consumer side of the U.S. smartphone market—iOS does not hold this position in Asia. Furthermore, I show that whether these restrictions harm consumers and developers depends critically on whether consumers view platforms as highly differentiated or close substitutes, the degree to which restrictions on super apps increase consumers’ switching costs and decrease developers’ multi-homing savings, and the number of apps operating on each platform.

- “Cheap Talk with Costly Information Acquisition by the Receiver”

Abstract: This paper examines the welfare implications of the receiver’s costly information acquisition in a cheap-talk model. I find that both a reduction in the cost of information acquisition and an increase in the informativeness of the information source can generate welfare gains, regardless of the welfare weights and whether receiver learning crowds out sender communication. Furthermore, a cost reduction improves welfare under broader conditions than an equivalent increase in informativeness.

Work in Progress

- “Interdependent Bargains with Downstream Competition and Vertical Merger”
with David Sibley and Yihang Zhou

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

As an Assistant Instructor

Semester	Course	
Fall 2025	ECO 329	Economic Statistics
Summer 2025	ECO n329	Economic Statistics-WB

As a Teaching Assistant

Semester	Course	Professor
Fall 2026	ECO 394K Microeconomics (Master level)	Gerald Oettinger
Spring 2026	ECO 352K Business Strategy	David Sibley
Fall 2024	ECO 353M Empirical Public Economics	David Sibley
Summer 2024	ECO f320L Macroeconomic Theory-WB	Trenton Herriford
Spring 2024	ECO 386D Microeconomics II (PhD level)	Svetlana Boyarchenko
Spring 2024	ECO 354K Introductory Game Theory	V. Bhaskar
Fall 2023	ECO 420K Microeconomic Theory	Gerald Oettinger
Summer 2023	ECO s395M 1-Real Analysis (Master level)	Kirk Blazek
Spring 2023	ECO 386D Microeconomics II (PhD level)	Svetlana Boyarchenko
Fall 2022	ECO 354K Introductory Game Theory	V. Bhaskar
Spring 2022	ECO 304K Introduction to Microeconomics	G. Dirk Mateer
Fall 2021	ECO 304K Intro to Microeconomics-WB	Charity-Joy Acchiardo & G. Dirk Mateer
Fall 2020	ECON 464 Competitive Strategy and Industrial Organization	Huseyin Yildirim

Others

Spring 2025	Supplemental Instruction Supervisor in Economics at Sanger Learning Center of the University of Texas at Austin
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SKILLS

Softwares & Tools	Matlab, Stata, Microsoft Office, L ^A T _E X
Language	English, professional working proficiency Mandarin, native or bilingual proficiency